

Paul Puccinelli

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EDUCATION

UC Berkeley

Bachelor of Arts, Economics

Bachelor of Arts, Statistics

- Undergraduate Economics Association
- Cal Alumni Association

Berkeley, CA

2023-2025

PROJECTS

Payroll Surprise Forecasting with Macroeconomic Data

- Built and end-to-end forecasting pipeline using public BLS and FRED macroeconomic data to model payroll surprise regimes and labor-market conditions.
- Engineered time-series features such as rolling averages and momentum indicators from job openings, hires, quits, and unemployment data to improve predictive signal.
- Developed and compared Ridge Regression and XGBoost models, using time-series cross-validation and hyperparameter tuning with RandomizedSearchCV.
- Evaluated model performance using ROC-AUC, MAE, and R^2 , achieving 0.768 ROC-AUC for upside-surprise classification and 0.751 ROC-AUC for downside-surprise classification.

paulpuccinelli.com | Webmaster & Developer

- Designed and built a fully responsive portfolio website from scratch using HTML, CSS and Javascript.
- Engineered a centralized design system using CSS custom properties for consistent typography, color theming, and styling across all pages and subpages.
- Built a functional contact form featuring client-side validation, live e-mail delivery via the EmailJS API, and a custom-coded slider CAPTCHA implemented in Javascript.
- Managed all source code using Git with a structured commit history, maintaining version control across iterative design, content and feature updates.

Independent Economics Blog | Writer & Analyst

- Published original, long-form economics commentary on a self-hosted portfolio site, covering fiscal policy, monetary economics, and financial market dynamics for a general but analytically informed audience.
- Authored "A Crisis of Economic Literacy" — an empirical analysis comparing consumer inflation expectations (University of Michigan Survey) against realized CPI data from FRED, alongside a comparative study of GDP, unemployment, and consumer sentiment; argued that asymmetric sentiment recovery creates structural distortions in how voters evaluate economic policy.
- Authored "Oil, Inflation, and the Bond Market" — a geopolitical-macro analysis of Iran conflict risk as a potential catalyst for Treasury market instability, tracing the transmission mechanism from oil supply disruption through inflation expectations, yield curve repricing, quantitative tightening dynamics, and stagflation risk
- Produced all embedded data visualizations independently using Python, sourcing primary data from the St. Louis Federal Reserve (FRED) and the University of Michigan consumer sentiment survey; published source code alongside each chart for full transparency

SKILLS / QUALIFICATIONS

Python | SQL | R/Rstudio | Node.js | HTML | CSS | JavaScript | Git/GitHub | PowerShell/Bash | Latex | Econometrics | Statistical Modeling | Feature Engineering | Data Visualization | Data Sourcing | Analytical Writing | Prompt Engineering | CFA Level I Candidate